Reading Environment and History through Tree Rings

Open the course in your browser

This introductory course is intended for learners new to dendrochronology. Previous training in tree-ring measurement or statistics is not required. Detailed mathematics and statistics are optional supplementary reading. No preparation is required for Lesson 1. Its videos support after-class review and independent study. Japanese and English slides and handouts are now v5. Videos follow earlier slides and await alignment.

Updated 4 November 2026: Lesson 4 slides and supplements have changed. The older offline ZIP and videos do not include these updates.

Lessons

- Lesson 1: Dating the past and reconstructing environments
- Lesson 2: Tree growth, wood anatomy and tree-ring structure
- Lesson 3: Principles of dendrochronology
- Lesson 4: Sampling, measurement and ring-width series
- Lesson 5: Dendroarchaeology
- Lesson 6: Dendroecology
- Lesson 7: Dendroclimatology
- Lesson 8: Research plans linking environment and history

Resources

- Background disciplines
- Disturbance biology
- Mathematics and statistics
- Imaging wood for tree-ring measurement
- Finding and reading research papers
- Glossary
- References and databases

Offline use

Complete package including videos

Extract the package and open START_HERE.html in this language folder.

Use and credits